

DIET

Theropods were the most powerful predators on land. They fed on insects, fish, other dinosaurs, small mammals, and bird-like creatures.



INSECTS

Insects evolved more than 350 million years ago.



FISH

Oceans and rivers teemed with fish.



DINOSAURS

Plant-eating dinosaurs provided food.



EARLY MAMMALS

Rodent-like mammals existed with dinosaurs.



EARLY BIRDS

Birds evolved from earlier theropod dinosaurs.

TEETH

Scientists can learn about dinosaurs from their fossilized skulls and teeth, which are often the only remaining parts. Carnivorous dinosaurs had lethal claws and sharp teeth.



KNIFE-LIKE

Theropods such as *Allosaurus* had sharp teeth that they used to slice meat from the bone.



SHARP POINTS

Baryonyx and other fish-eating theropods had pointed needle-like teeth that pierced fish skin.



CRUSHING BONES

The large teeth of *Tyrannosaurus rex* crushed straight through bone.

PACK HUNTING

A pack of *Deinonychus* attacks a large plant-eating *Tenontosaurus*. Evidence from fossilized dinosaur footprints suggests that some dinosaurs hunted in packs. Probably they did not herd prey but worked together to bring down larger dinosaurs.



DUBREUILLOSAURUS

CARCHARODONTOSAURUS

ALBERTOSAURUS

ALLOSAURUS

TYRANNOSAURUS REX

Stiff, pointed tail counterbalances huge head and allows dinosaur to turn quickly

Powerful legs with four clawed toes, only three of which are weight-bearing

DEEP BITES FROM TYRANNOSAURUS HAVE BEEN FOUND IN FOSSILIZED TRICERATOPS BONES